

The Lost Document

It was a glorious Sunday evening. A gentle **breeze caressed** Muskaan's **unruly** hair and the scent of blooming flowers filled the air.

"Mom," Muskaan shouted, **peering** through the kitchen window. "Can I ride my bicycle? I have finished my homework."

"Of course you can," said Mrs. Dixit lovingly, "but only after you drink a cup of milk."

Muskaan **screwed up** her nose and hurried inside. She knew through prior experience that Mom's rules were meant to be followed.

While Muskaan finished the milk, her mother **brushed** her hair.

"Off you go now," said Mrs. Dixit **cheerfully**.

"Going somewhere, Muskaan?" asked Mr. Dixit, seeing her **dragging** out the cycle from the parking area near the kennel.

"Yes, Dad," said Muskaan. "Just for a ride."

"In that case," continued Mr. Dixit, "why don't you ride to the photostat shop in the neighbourhood and get a paper Xeroxed?"

"Sure, Dad. Give it to me."

Mr. Dixit hurried to the cupboard and **extracted** a paper from a folder.

"This is a very important document, Muskaan, so keep it safely. I would have got it done myself, but your Mom and I have to visit the Sethis today."

"Don't you worry, Dad. I will get it done."

Mrs. Dixit looked worriedly at her husband. She knew through experience that her twelve-year-old daughter was very careless. But Mr. Dixit only smiled and said, "She has to learn, doesn't she?"

Muskaan got the paper Xeroxed and was returning when she saw her friends playing cricket in the garden. She **rushed** to join them, totally forgetting the document that **lay** in the basket of her cycle.

It was getting dark when Muskaan reached home. Dadaji was outside the house, taking their pet dog, Bruno, for a walk.

"My dear child," said Dadaji **affectionately**. "Did you **have a good time**?"



"You know, Dadaji, I hit two sixes today!" said Muskaan excitedly.

"That's great! Have you got the paper Xeroxed? Your father told me to keep it safely in the cupboard."

The colour drained from Muskaan's face. In the excitement of playing cricket, she had forgotten about the paper.

"Of course, Dadaji," she lied. "It is there in the cycle. I will bring it and you can keep it in the cupboard." And saying that, she rushed out.

The basket was empty. Perhaps, the pages had **blown away**. Muskaan was **frantic**. What could she do now? What would Papa say? Her mind raced. She had to think of a plan before Mom and Dad returned.

"Dad!" said Muskaan, running to meet her parents at the gate. "I got the paper Xeroxed but when I reached home Bruno **pounced** on me and **tore the sheet to shreds**."

Dad would forget all about it, thought Muskaan. But Mr. Dixit looked **furious**.

"What!" he cried. "Bruno **ruined** the paper?"

"Yes, Dad," said Muskaan **timidly**. There was little she could do now. She had to stick to her story.

Mr. Dixit looked at his wife and **winked**.

"I think," he said **sternly**, "Bruno is in need of serious disciplining. I am going to **give him a piece of my mind**. And no dinner for him today."

Muskaan looked at the expression on her father's face. Poor little Bruno, she thought **miserably**. He would have to go without dinner for no fault of his.

Mr. Dixit picked up a stick and hurried to the **kennel**. Muskaan stood at the steps **fidgiting**. What a mess she had landed into!

"You naughty dog!" she heard her Dad say. Was Dad **thrashing** Bruno? Muskaan rushed to the kennel, tears rolling down her eyes.

"Please stop, Dad!" said Muskaan. "It's not Bruno's fault."

"But didn't you say he tore the paper?"

"Actually, Dad, I lost the paper and did not have the courage to own up."

"In that case, Bruno can have his dinner," said Dad.



While Bruno **gulped down** the food, Mom looked at Muskaan.

“Tell me something, Muskaan, why did you own up now?” she said.

Muskaan **pondered** for a moment and then said, “I really couldn’t let Bruno be punished for something that was not his fault. I thought I would escape by putting the blame on him but honestly, this felt much worse.”

Dad smiled and said, “Just remember to be more responsible in future.”

“Muskaan learnt a valuable lesson today,” said Mrs. Dixit later when Muskaan was asleep, “but you lost an important document.”

Mr. Dixit laughed **heartily**. “My dear,” he said. “What I gave her was just an old printout!”

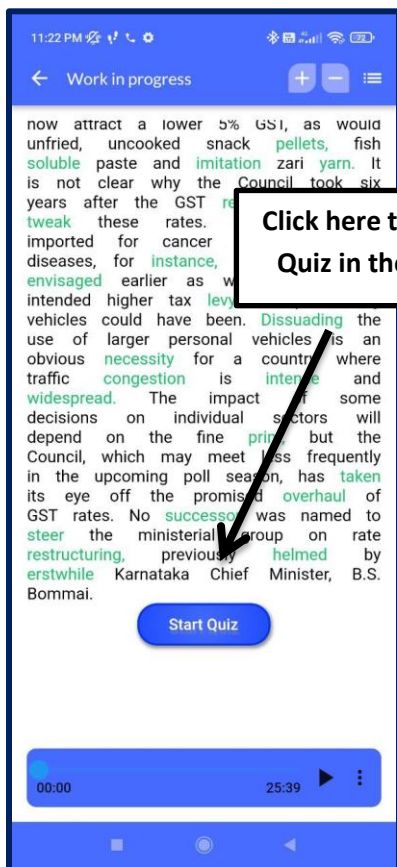
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Vocabulary

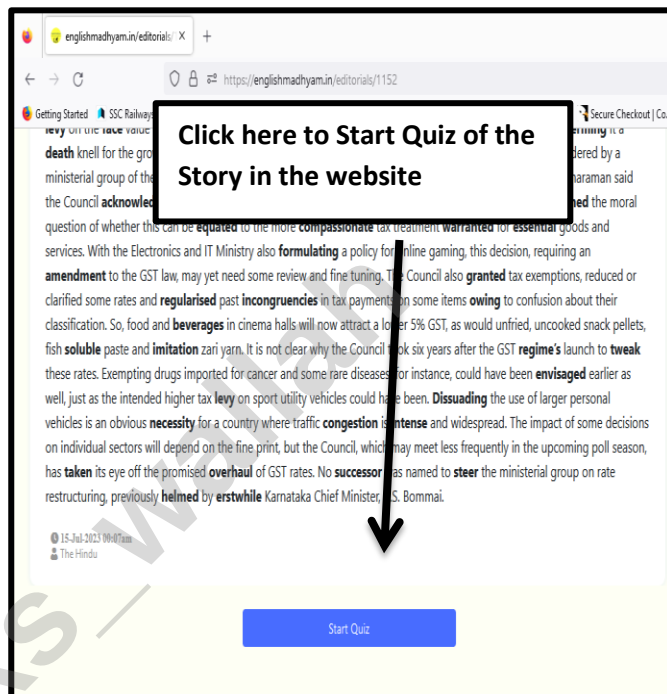
1. **Breeze** (noun) – wind, gust, airflow, draft, zephyr – हल्की हवा
2. **Caress** (verb) – stroke, touch, pat, fondle, cuddle – प्यार से सहलाना
3. **Unruly** (adjective) – disorderly, wild, untidy, unmanageable, rowdy – बेकाबू
4. **Peer** (verb) – look, gaze, squint, glance, observe – झांकना
5. **Screw up** (phrasal verb) – distort, pucker, crumple, frown, wrinkle – (चेहरा) बिगाड़ना
6. **Brush** (verb) – comb, smooth, stroke, tidy, groom – कंघी करना
7. **Off you go** (phrase) – you may leave, go ahead, move on, get going, proceed – अब जाओ
8. **Cheerfully** (adverb) – happily, gladly, joyfully, brightly, delightfully – प्रसन्नता से
9. **Drag** (verb) – pull, haul, tow, draw, tug – घसीटना
10. **Extract** (verb) – take out, remove, draw, withdraw, retrieve – निकालना
11. **Rush** (verb) – hurry, dash, race, bolt, speed – दौड़ना / जल्दी करना
12. **Lay** (verb) – place, put, rest, set down, deposit – रखना
13. **Affectionately** (adverb) – lovingly, warmly, fondly, kindly, tenderly – स्नेह से
14. **Have a good time** (phrase) – enjoy, have fun, be happy, feel good, amuse oneself – अच्छा समय बिताना
15. **The colour drain from someone's face** (phrase) – become pale, look shocked, lose complexion, go white, turn pale – चेहरा फीका पड़ जाना
16. **Blew away** (phrasal verb) – fly off, be carried away, scatter, drift off, vanish – उड़ जाना
17. **Frantic** (adjective) – panicked, frenzied, distressed, agitated, hysterical – व्याकुल
18. **Pounce** (verb) – jump, leap, lunge, spring, attack – झपटना
19. **Tear something to shred** (phrase) – destroy, rip apart, mangle, ruin, shred – टुकड़े-टुकड़े करना
20. **Furious** (adjective) – angry, enraged, livid, incensed, fuming – बहुत क्रोधित
21. **Ruin** (verb) – spoil, damage, destroy, wreck, mess up – बर्बाद करना
22. **Timidly** (adverb) – shyly, nervously, fearfully, hesitantly, meekly – डरते हुए
23. **Wink** (verb) – blink, signal, gesture, squint, flutter – आंख मारना

24. **Sternly** (adverb) – strictly, firmly, seriously, harshly, severely – सख्ती से
25. **Give someone a piece of mind** (phrase) – scold, reprimand, rebuke, tell off, criticize – डांटना / फटकार लगाना
26. **Miserably** (adverb) – unhappily, sorrowfully, wretchedly, gloomily, dejectedly – दुखी होकर
27. **Kennel** (noun) – doghouse, shelter, dog shed, pet house, animal pen – कुत्ते का घर
28. **Fidget** (verb) – squirm, twitch, fuss, shuffle, move restlessly – बेचैनी से हिलना
29. **Thrash** (verb) – beat, whip, hit, strike, lash – पीटना
30. **Gulp down** (phrasal verb) – swallow quickly, devour, drink fast, consume, chug – तेजी से निगलना
31. **Ponder** (verb) – think, reflect, consider, contemplate, mull – सोच-विचार करना
32. **Heartily** (adverb) – enthusiastically, cheerfully, sincerely, warmly, thoroughly – दिल से / हँसी से

Practice Exercise



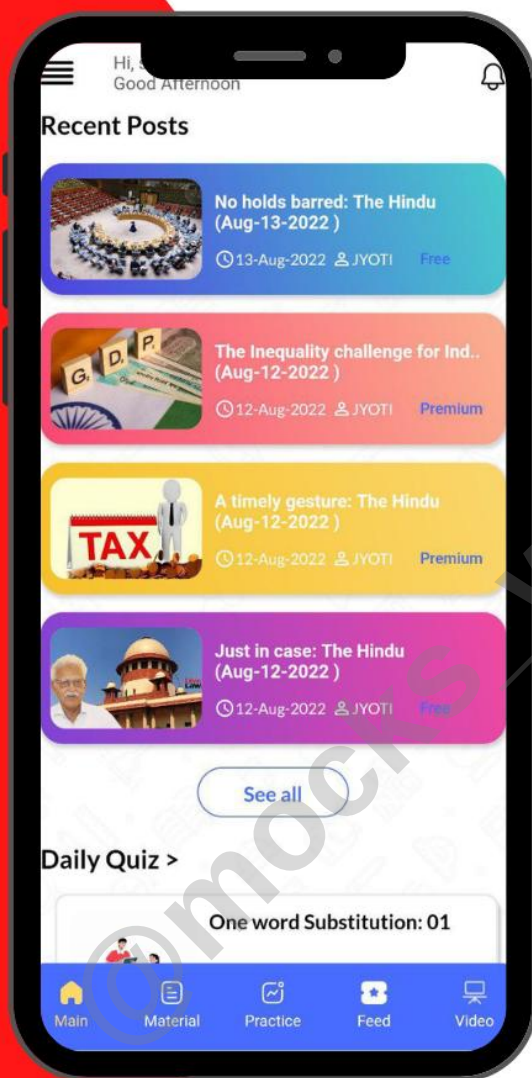
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